Ebudola Adegoke

Datafrik Capstone project 2

Ignite Cohort (October 2026)

Target Institution: Commercial Bank / Financial Institution (Corporate & SME Banking Division)

Project Lead: Ebudola Adegoke

Chosen Project: Fintech, Dee Bank SME Merchant Onboarding and Settlement Visibility

Date: October 2026

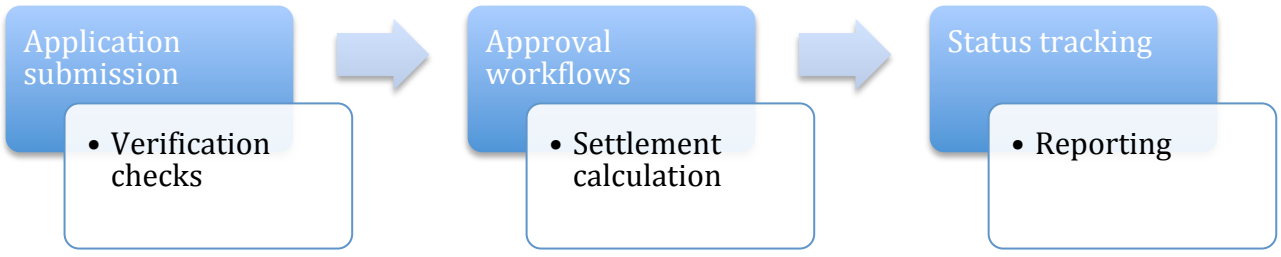
Task 1: BUSINESS PLAN

Project Background

Business Situation, Purpose and Objective: Many small business merchants struggle with slow onboarding times, unclear requirements with no clear view of when funds from sales will arrive in their bank accounts. This causes cash flow uncertainty, frustration, and delays in business planning. This project analyses the current process, redesigns improved or automated requirements and workflows to speed up onboarding and give merchants full real-time transaction settlement visibility.

Scope: This project covers the end-to-end process for Small and Medium-sized Enterprise (SME) merchants applying to join a payments platform, through to receiving funds from customer transactions. It includes reviewing current onboarding delays, unclear status updates, and lack of settlement transparency. The goal is to design a clearer, faster, more visible process as shown below for In scope and Out scope

In Scope:



Out Scope:



Business Analysis Approach Strategy

Methodology: Hybrid (Agile/Adaptive with structured requirements governance

Rationale: Integrating with third-party verification APIs and core database ledgers requires structured upfront requirements (BRD/FRD) to satisfy risk and regulatory standards.

Work Plan

Tasks	**Key BA Activities**	**Output Deliverables**
Task 1 & 2	Document BA approach, scopes and identify key stakeholders	BA planning and Stakeholder Analysis
Task 3 & 4	Conduct 5 Whys/Fishbone analysis, write SMART goals, run role play interview simulations	Problem, Solution & Strategy Analysis, Question Bank & Elicitation Log
Task 5 & 6	Define Business Rules, write functional & non functional requirements, set MOSCOW priorities	Business Requirements Document (BRD), FRD & Traceability Table
Task 7	Process Modelling (AS-IS and TO-BE workflows	Flows done in Miro (with at least 2 exception paths)
Presentation & Submission	Prepare the 8-10 slide presentation and organize Google drive folder deliverables	Final slide presentation, shared drive with Datafrik and the Facilitator

Communications & Stakeholder Update Plan:

This project is to be completed in 10 working days with an update provided to the key industry stakeholders every 3 working days.

Task 2: STAKEHOLDER ANALYSIS

Stakeholder Register

S/No	Stakeholder Role	Perspective (Internal/External)	Interest & Need	Power & Influence	Engagement approach	Validation Status
1	Senior Management/ Project Sponsors	Internal	High	High	Milestone updates, Approves budget & final recommendations & presentations	Confirmed
2	Compliance Team	Internal	High	High	Interview from early stage to identify rules & constraints	Confirmed
3	Finance & Reconciliation team	Internal	High	High	Interviews on settlement timelines	Assumed
4	IT & Engineering Internal	Internal	Low	High	Review approach early & clarify constraints	Assumed
5	Product Manager	Internal	High	High	Review findings & Recommendations	Assumed
6	Fraud Team	Internal	Low	Low	Detect Anomalies	Assumed
7	Product Onboarding team	Internal	High	Low	Document review, Process walkthrough Interviews, Shadowing(sometimes)	Confirmed
8	Customer Support Team	Internal	High	Low	Interviews on pain points	Confirmed
9	End users (SME Merchants)	External	High	Low	Survey Questions	Assumed

POWER-INTEREST MATRIX

Stakeholder(s)	High Interest	Low Interest
High Power	**Manage Closely** • Senior Management • Compliance • Finance & Reconciliation • Product Manager	**Keep Satisfied** • IT/Engineering Team
Low Power	**Keep Informed** • Product Onboarding team • Customer support team • End Users	**Monitor** • Fraud Team

Engagement Plan:

- **Manage closely:** These stakeholders have high influence and high interest. They signoff budgets, approvals, Involve in key decisions and validate requirements early while they require high level/frequent updates during project lifecycle
- **Keep Informed:** These category require regular updates on progress, changes, upcoming milestones. Frequent communication is important to some stakeholders on this category for product knowledge.
- **Monitor:** They only get engaged/notify appropriate stakeholders when issues arise after product goes live that require urgent attention.
- **Keep Satisfied:** The IT Engineers build recommended dashboard and launch products. Although they have high power but low interest as they are busy with other projects. The Management team can also be categorized under keep satisfied as they want all boxes checked.

Task 3: Problem Statement

SME merchants onboarding process requirements and settlement timeline is quite unclear and disjointed. Applications come in through different channels with no standard checklist, teams work from separate tools and use inconsistent communication means. Merchants can't easily see where they stand or when their funds arrive in their accounts. This causes frustration for business owners, extra work for support and operations teams, and uncertainty about what's actually happening at each step.

Root Analysis and Fish Bone Diagram

PS: These are attached in another file in the drive

SMART OBJECTIVES

Objective 1: To reduce merchant support enquiries about application status and settlement timing by atleast 50% within 6weeks of launching the new process.

SMART	How it applies
Specific	Enquiries specifically about status and settlement
Measurable	Takes note of tickets in these categories before vs after launch
Achievable	A simple dashboard and timeline answers most of these instantly

Relevant	This is the biggest pain point management flagged
Time-bound	Within 6 weeks of launch

Objective 2: To Ensure 100% of new merchant applicants receive a complete document checklist and estimated review timeline at the moment they submit their application for effective settlement visibility.

SMART	How it applies
Specific	Every applicant gets both checklist and review timeline
Measurable	Survey is sent to Merchants for Clarity
Achievable	Involves a process change, a new tech not needed.
Relevant	Incomplete applications, Missing documents are the primary cause of delays
Time-bound	From day one of the new process

Objective 3: To Establish a single, shared source of truth for application status where all internal teams share same consistent information to the Merchant.

SMART	How it applies
Specific	Product knowledge becomes visible to everyone

Measurable	Does the merchant dashboard view matches the internal view?
Achievable	We do it step by step, the words first and then step by step
Relevant	Inconsistent language causes confusion and wrong answers
Time-bound	Within 3 months

Gap Analysis

This has been completed on Miro, labelled and attached in the shared drive

Options and Reasoned recommendation

Two distinct approaches were evaluated:

- **Option 1 (Process & Communication First)**: To standardize checklists, agree on a single source of truth, and use a shared tracking board working within current tools. This delivers improvements in 1–2 weeks at low cost and low risk, but manual work remains, enquiries will gradually return as volumes grow, and merchants still cannot check status independently.
- **Option 2 (Technology-Enabled System):** To build a merchant self-service dashboard, central workflow platform, and automated notifications. This tackles all root causes permanently, scales seamlessly, and creates a reliable single source of truth but takes about 6 weeks to deliver, it requires budget and IT resources, and needs careful rollout and training.

Recommended Approach: Hybrid, The business is advised to start with Option 1 now and thereafter build towards Option 2

Option 1 alone will not resolve the underlying inefficiencies, while Option 2 alone leaves merchants and teams waiting longer for relief. Combining both delivers immediate clarity and consistency while the lasting solution is developed.

This approach balances speed with long-term value: merchants gain confidence and transparency quickly, while customer support team are free from repetitive enquiries and other teams are free from frequent escalations. Dee Bank establishes the scalable foundation needed for growth and success will be measured against confirmed enquiry baselines, with settlement calculations and compliance requirements validated at every stage.